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# Classroom Access Checklist

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## FOR THE GEN-ED TEACHER WELCOMING A DHH STUDENT

# Classroom Access Checklist: Setup Guide for DHH Students in Gen Ed

A quick-reference checklist for the room a Deaf or hard-of-hearing (DHH) student joins — the itinerant in-service one-pager, reshaped as something you can actually check off. Students get to this point however they communicate: ASL, spoken language, a hearing device, or a combination. This list is about your classroom setup, not their hearing.

## Before day one

- ☐ Seating gives the student a clear sightline to your face and to the board at the same time.
- ☐ Lighting checked — no window or bright light behind you when you speak (backlighting hides your face).
- ☐ If an interpreter, notetaker, or paraprofessional supports this student, you know where they'll sit and that the student can see both of you.
- ☐ You've confirmed which accommodations are on the IEP or 504 with the case manager or Teacher of the Deaf — not guessed at them.
- ☐ You know who to contact (ToD, case manager) with questions before the first day, not after something goes wrong.

## Every day

- ☐ Face the class when you're speaking — not the board, not your screen.
- ☐ Repeat or rephrase a classmate's comment before you respond to it; the room only heard one side of that exchange.
- ☐ Captions are on for any video, no exceptions, checked before you press play.
- ☐ You check in privately about understanding, rather than asking "did you get that?" in front of peers.

## Communication repair: when a message didn't land

Every classroom has moments where something doesn't get across the first time. What you do next matters more than what happened.

- ☐ **Rephrase it** — different words, not the same sentence louder.
- ☐ **Write the key words** on the board or hand them over on paper.
- ☐ **Confirm privately** that the repair worked, rather than assuming it did.

## Common accommodations, at a glance

| Accommodation        | What it looks like in your room                                                                                               |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Preferential seating | Near the front, with a clear line of sight to your face and the board — not necessarily “front row center” for every student. |
| Captions on video    | Turned on before the video starts, every time, for the whole class.                                                           |
| Repeat / rephrase    | You restate classmates' comments and directions before moving on, without being asked.                                        |
| Visual backup        | Key directions also written on the board or handed out, not spoken only.                                                      |

**About remote microphone / FM systems:** some DHH students use a remote microphone or FM system as part of their supports. If this student does, their ToD or family will show you how it works and what your part is — we keep this checklist to the pedagogy side of the room. This resource is informational; follow your audiologist's and IEP team's guidance for anything about hearing technology.

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